

Types of Biblical Study Emphasis

Textual Criticism. Purpose, to determine the best possible and most accurate reading of the ancient text. This had some development in the ancient world and is pursued by all branches of Christianity as the accuracy of the written text is very important in both Christian and Jewish traditions.

Historical Criticism. This relates the biblical text to surrounding history and acknowledges the different levels of accuracy in the different materials, i.e. the Samuel/Kings information is to be preferred under most circumstances as it is more accurate than Chronicles. The Documentary Theory of the Old Testament is a development of this study.

Religionsgeschichte (History of Religion). This was a scholarly development of the general study of religion which was later applied to the Bible in light of other living world's religions. It sees the Bible as one of the world's religious documents with the

religious concerns met by

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Form Criticism. This development separated the text into literary forms and their oral antecedents with comparison with other ancient near eastern writings. This is an attempt to get behind the present text to the reading of the text in the past. It asks the questions of the situation in life at the time of the beginning of the incident or story.

Redaction Criticism—deals with seeing the editorial additions and comments of the later editors of the various books of both testaments. This is used to see first what the redactor has added then the other strands discerned from content.

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Documentary theory. Julian Wellhausen (1844-1919) demonstrated that Hebrew Scriptures are multi-layered. They are written by many different authors at different times in Israel's history covering from about 900 B.C.E. to about 400 B.C.E. must ask what was the historical time something was written?

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